

EPISODE 12 (SESSION 1)

A Mission Realized

PRIMARY TEXT: GENESIS 24, 26

Imagine Rebekah. Climbing down into the cistern once, twice, too many times to count. After a dozen times slipping and spilling the contents of the jar, to have to turn around and refill it again. Arms tired, sweat dripping. With a smile, or lips pursed in determination?

Young and willing to sacrifice, show hospitality and kindness, and lean into a new calling away from her home.

Imagine Isaac. Returning to a land promised to his father—to him. Digging one well, then forced to another, and another. Calluses forming, arms burning. Sighs born of exhaustion from a good day's work, or exasperation?

The leader of the young *beit av* willing to sacrifice what is rightfully his, show hospitality and kindness, and lean into this newly realized mission from God.

Imagine yourself as a college student today. Perhaps confused. Perhaps angry. Perhaps hopeful and ready to take on the world. Perhaps discouraged and ready to give up. Ready to show kindness, and very much in need of radical, life-changing hospitality. To have others climb into the cistern for you not once or twice, but over and over again. To watch someone dig a well, then move on, seeing none of the benefits themselves.

**Imagine yourself
as a college
student today...**

To see the world through the eyes of the Creator.
To see humanity partnering with God.
To see what it is to be a blessing.
To see what it is to live in intimacy with God.
To see believers letting go and trusting the Story.
To see the character of God through His followers.

As we read the next chapter of this great narrative in Genesis, we see the mission become more fully realized. Of one father handing the promise to bless the nations down to the next, to continue partnering with God for generations to come.

Today, we don't have to think of this simply within our own family unit—although that is not to be disregarded. We can consider how the faith we have and the stories we tell impact the next generation. Those young adults entering the workforce who need guidance. Those young stay-at-home mothers or fathers who face feelings of isolation and inadequacy. And those college students who enter a campus with so many hopes and dreams for the future just as reality decides to rear its ugly head.

If you are not one of those college-aged students—if you’ve lived through this life stage and find yourself here, ask, who did you need then? Did you find them? What could have been different if you had? What do you wish you’d known?

BEMA Discipleship is more than just a podcast. It’s a campus ministry that seeks to bridge this gap, and it’s not easy. Just like climbing down into cisterns or digging endless, seemingly pointless wells, it is hard work. But it’s worth it. We invite you to join us too. Look for those generations to come alongside and disciple. Ask them questions, seek to know them. Show them radical hospitality and walk through their joys and sorrows and celebrations with them.

**We can realize
and pursue this
mission as well.**

The Text models this for us from one generation to the next, and we, as the Church, can realize and pursue this mission with the future leaders of our churches and nations and communities as well.

PRAYER

*Father God,
May we be selfless
Selfless like Rebekah, going far beyond what is required of us
—even for the stranger
May we be selfless
Selfless like Isaac, sacrificing what is rightfully ours
—even in the face of injustice
May we be faithful
Faithful to your Story, your mission, your calling
So others may be changed and souls may be saved
because of the powerful, very real
Story we are participants in.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 12

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

How could you meditate over these parts of the Story? What Text could you continue to meditate on, memorize, or dig deeper into?



COMMUNITY

In what ways does your community show radical hospitality? Or how could it? In what ways can you go above and beyond or experience life with others—even if it makes life different than you'd planned?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life would benefit from a mentor-like relationship? What young adults or people near you need guidance and reminders to trust the Story? Who could you disciple? How can you disciple them in a way of radical hospitality?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this lesson? About Isaac and Rebekah? The servant and his sign from God? How to show hospitality without being a doormat? The struggle is real—it's good!



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*We believe that **if we do our part of creating space for God, He will fill it.** We want BEMA to foster practices that enable the Holy Spirit to do a work in and through us all. How have you, or could you, create a space that God can fill? Different spiritual disciplines or discipleship? You are a part of the promise to God, and creating a space is a way of making ourselves open to God and moments to show radical hospitality. You never know when God may lead you to a cistern or to dig a well!*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

*We believe young adults are shaping the future of this world, and they need the blessings and care of people like you. In what ways could you come alongside young adults to show them acts of love, hospitality, and even sacrifice? How might this bring them closer to God and ultimately impact the world—not just you? **Contact us about our college mentor program if you're just not sure where to start!***

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*This may be about what we do at work—but it's also about the individuals we interact with each day. Do we carry the promise to bless the world with us always, or only when it is convenient or safe? Do we work solely for our own security, or look for opportunities to bless others within our workplace—the office, the home, the shop, the store, etc.? Are we willing to let others prosper from what was promised to us, or to do more than is asked simply because someone needs the help? **The work we do every day is sacred. It matters to the Kingdom!***